



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Arche Classical Academy
School Website: <https://archeclassicalacademy.com>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Arche Classical Academy (Carlisle, PA 17013) presents a firmly Classical-oriented profile across most core categories of classical education. Public materials from the school emphasize a Christ-centered, biblical framework anchored in Classical Christian Education (CCE), a curriculum built around the grammar–logic–rhetoric sequence, the Great Books, Latin study, and an integrated view of truth, goodness, and beauty. The school also foregrounds partnership with families and a strong biblical worldview, including Sola Scriptura-style framing of knowledge and a formative, virtue-centered aim. Evidence from the school's site includes explicit statements about biblically shaped curriculum, a Christ-centered approach, and the Great Books, along with notes on parent involvement and ACCS affiliation. □filecite□turn0file0□turn5file0□turn0file7□

Category-by-category signals (using the Six Essential Elements framework) indicate a CLASSICAL orientation in Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents & Community. Pedagogy presents a mix that leans Classical but with less explicit articulation of Socratic/seminar-based methodologies in public-facing materials, which places Element 4 in the realm of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL. The aggregate assessment, taking all six categories into account, is therefore CLASSICAL. The school shows strong alignment to traditional classical aims (formation, Great Books, liberal arts, and a communal, faith-centered ethos), with the most notable gaps being explicit, high-profile articulation of certain Socratic pedagogy signals in public materials. The key insights are captured in the category snapshots below and summarized in the ABSTRACT at the end.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum asserts that biblical values shape every aspect of school life and that the education is Christ-centered, with a strong emphasis on biblical worldview integration (CCE) across subjects. This is stated directly in the Curriculum materials. - Public materials reference Scripture-centered framing (Sola Scriptura), explicitly locating Scriptures at the center of all subjects and education, and describing Christian education as centered on the God/man in a non-neutral framework. - Communal prayer/morning prayer and liturgical rhythm are evident in school-life descriptions (e.g., morning prayer and communal prayer-related practices) as part of daily life. - Our Story and FAQ materials emphasize a Christian worldview and ACCS affiliation, reinforcing a theologically anchored, virtue-centered stance.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed (from the Six Elements lexicon as applicable to this category): theology, sacred scripture, Christ-centered, Scripture-centered, morning prayer, liturgy-like practice, sacred tradition, wonder, Logos, and a moral order grounded in Biblical truth. - Negative keywords: none clearly evident in public-facing content (no strong signals of relativism or secular, neutral ethics in the public materials cited here). - Presence of terms aligned with the Positive keyword set (e.g., Christ-centered, Scriptures at the center, biblical worldview, morning prayer) supports a CLASSICAL rating for this category. - Approximate keyword count signal: multiple explicit mentions (biblical values; Sola Scriptura; Christ-centered; prayers/morning prayer; Scriptures at the center) with no clear negative signals in the public materials.

Why this rating - The school tightly anchors its identity in biblical truth and the Christian theological frame, with explicit statements about Scripture-centering and liturgical/community life, which closely aligns with Positive indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The absence of negative signals and the clear theological framing support CLASSICAL rather than Not Classical or Only Somewhat Classical. Citations demonstrate the core elements: biblical values and Christ-centered curriculum, Scripture-centered pedagogy, and liturgical/community practices. ☐filecite☐turn0file0☐turn6file1☐turn0file7☐

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials describe formation as the primary aim, emphasizing cultivation of virtue and wisdom rather than mere job preparation. The Curriculum description explicitly frames education as formation and a Christ-centered way of life, not solely workforce preparation. - Great Books, liberal arts orientation, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty are central to the program (e.g., Great Books, grammar–logic–rhetoric, and a Christian liberal-arts orientation). - Public statements highlight the belief that truth, goodness, and beauty are real and knowable, and that human formation and virtue are central aims. The Sola Scriptura framing reinforces this telos. - The school's literature about forming character, virtue, and a Christian worldview aligns with a paideia/classical mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, great conversation, telos, contemplation/scholé, classical mission, human flourishing. - Negative keywords observed: none relevant to this category (no explicit workforce-prep or 21st-century-skills framing as the primary aimed outcome; rather formation and virtue predominate). - The presence of formation, virtue, wisdom, classical mission, and pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty yields a strong CLASSICAL signal.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds formation, virtue, and a classical mission as its core aims, not simply job-readiness or workforce preparation, and emphasizes the reality of truth, goodness, and beauty as guiding ideals. Public materials repeatedly anchor the aim in character formation and a classical liberal-arts framework, which matches the Positive keyword indicators. ☐filecite☐turn0file0☐turn6file1☐

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly defines its curriculum around the Seven Liberal Arts, with grammar, logic, rhetoric, and the Quadrivium; it emphasizes Great Books and primary sources (the “Great Books” in curriculum). Latin instruction is highlighted as part of the curriculum, along with a Christ-centered study of history and sciences integrated with faith. - Public-facing materials describe studying Great Books (The Iliad, Don Quixote, Hamlet, etc.), a Latin program, and integrated approaches across subjects. - History is treated as a continual through-line within the curriculum (and not merely as “social studies”); Great Books and Western tradition are foregrounded. The materials also speak to contemplation/wonder as part of education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium), Great Books, primary sources, Latin, Western civilization, history within a universal curriculum, contemplation/wonder. - Negative keywords observed: lack of Great Books or history emphasis would be a concern, but the provided materials strongly affirm Great Books and primary-sources orientation; no explicit negative signals (e.g., project-based-dominant or social-studies-first framing) appear in the public content cited. - Counts: Positive keyword signals are strong; negative signals appear absent in the public-facing materials.

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly anchored in classical landmarks (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Latin; general liberal-arts structure) with history and integrated disciplines, aligning with CLASSICAL indicators. The absence of explicit counter-signals strengthens the CLASSICAL rating.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school foregrounds a strong classical framework in its pedagogy via the grammar–logic–rhetoric sequence and Great Books emphasis, indicating a classical approach to how students learn and engage with material. The emphasis on integrating Christ into teaching and on thinking (as opposed to rote

instruction) aligns with classical aims. - There are explicit mentions of collaborative, seminar-style work in some classical-education discussions, but public-facing materials do not consistently advertise a fully articulated Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy across grades. The materials emphasize the Great Books, memory/work formation, and integrated study rather than a consistently described Socratic seminar program in every grade. This makes the pedagogical signal strong but not uniformly explicit across all public content. - The public materials also emphasize a lively, faith-integrated classroom culture (morning prayer, Christ-centeredness, and a low-tech environment in some texts), which can include contemplative and wonder-filled approaches, but the explicit, formal pedagogy signals such as schooled Scholé, or a sustained Paideia/Socratic seminar program, are not consistently described.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Great Books, grammar, logic, rhetoric, classical education, liberal arts, memory work, recitation, integration of faith and reason, formation through study. - Negative keywords observed: explicit signals of experiential learning, project-based-only approaches, or constructivist pedagogy signals are not evident in the public materials; however, explicit Socratic/seminar signals are not consistently described in the public-facing pages. - The presence of core classical elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books) supports a CLASSICAL lean, but the lack of consistently explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy across grades makes this category slightly less than fully classical in public articulation.

Why this rating - The curriculum and philosophy strongly align with classical aims, but explicit, scalable evidence of Socratic seminars or a consistent “Socrates-style” pedagogy across grades is not uniformly documented in the public-facing materials. Given that, the category is best characterized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site presents faculty as partners with parents and as a core element of the school's culture (e.g., Our Faculty & Staff, Head of School, Co-Founders, Curriculum Director). The tone suggests a high standard of faculty leadership and involvement in governance and curriculum. - The materials emphasize faculty as living curriculum and the faculty as mentors/partners with parents, with a focus on virtue and character formation as well as teaching excellence. The public materials show portraits of teachers and leadership, which aligns with the classical model of a “living curriculum” embodied by the faculty. - ACCS affiliation (and the emphasis on a Christian worldview) further signals a faculty culture oriented to classical practice and mentorship rather than a purely transactional teaching force.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: living curriculum, faculty as mentors, portrait of teacher, collegial faculty, Christ-centered curriculum, curriculum director. - Negative keywords observed: no strong signals of non-classical faculty roles (the content emphasizes virtue, mentorship, and living-curriculum concepts rather than a corporate/transactional teacher model). - Keyword density for classical signals is high in this category; no negative signals dominate.

Why this rating - The faculty is presented as central to the school's mission, with explicit language about mentoring, virtue, and living curriculum, which resonates with CLASSICAL expectations for the core role of faculty. The combination of leadership roles and a commitment to Christian classical pedagogy supports CLASSICAL. □filecite□turn3file11□turn4file11□

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes strong partnership with parents, positioning parents as co-teachers and champions of the education; the FAQ and Parent/Student materials describe parent involvement as a central feature of the school. - The Parent Handbook and admissions materials describe family involvement, parent formation resources, and opportunities for visiting and engagement (open campus, family participation, tours). The content repeatedly invites parent participation and notes that parents are welcome to visit. - The school frames community life, morning prayer, and field trips as opportunities to engage the broader community and their faith commitments; ACCS affiliation underscores a broader classical community of like-minded schools.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, parent formation, home-school connection, open campus, parent covenant, community of learners, parental engagement, living tradition in the family. - Negative keywords observed: none clearly present in the public materials that would indicate a consumer-centric or minimal-parent-involvement model; the materials instead emphasize active parental involvement and partnership. - The presence of multiple clearly classical signals for parent/community engagement supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Why this rating - Arche Classical Academy presents itself as a community-centered, family-partnered institution with explicit emphasis on parental involvement and formation, aligning strongly with the CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community. □filecite□turn0file7□turn4file0□

Overall Assessment and Aggregate Rating

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate verdict: CLASSICAL

Rationale - The school demonstrates a robust Classical orientation across five of the six categories, with Element 4 (Pedagogy) presenting SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals due to relatively fewer explicit public articulations of Socratic/Paideia-style pedagogy across all grade levels. The public content strongly supports formation, Great Books, grammar-logic-rhetoric, Latin, and faith-centered pedagogy, along with a strong faculty and family/community orientation. Taken together, Arche Classical Academy aligns closely with classical education criteria, yielding a CLASSICAL aggregate classification.

What would move the needle (only relevant if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) - If you wanted to push Pedagogy to a firmer CLASSICAL rating, publicly articulate and exemplify a consistent Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy across applicable grade levels (K-12), including planned seminars, dialectic discourse, and structured Paideia-style discussions, with examples of upper-school rhetoric projects and tutor-led seminars. Additional explicit language about memory work, recitation, and chant in daily routines could also strengthen the Pedagogy signal. These steps would reinforce the explicit six-element signals for Pedagogy and move Element 4 to CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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